

UNIT 80



PUTTING OUT FIRES

CONVERSATION

Derek: Alright, we've received reports of a data breach yesterday. Customers are understandably concerned their information may have been exposed. What do we know at this point?

Melissa: At no time were payment details or passwords compromised. The breach was limited to basic account information, and the system was locked down immediately once it was identified.

Derek: Okay. But how did this happen in the first place?

Melissa: Not until the security team reviewed login activity did we realize an external support tool had been misconfigured. Only after that discovery did we disable it.

Derek: That's still serious. Our customers trust us to safeguard their data.

Melissa: Absolutely. By no means are we downplaying it. We're taking the matter seriously and acting in good faith with every affected customer.

Derek: And what are we doing to prevent this going forward?

Melissa: Under no circumstances will this be allowed to happen again. We've tightened internal controls, we're holding ourselves accountable, and the focus now is to restore confidence and put this behind us.



VOCABULARY



Put this behind
us



Act in good
faith



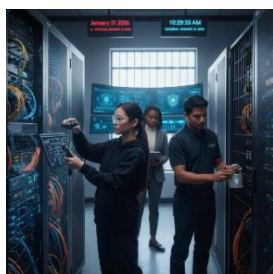
Get to the
bottom of the
issue



Hold oneself
accountable



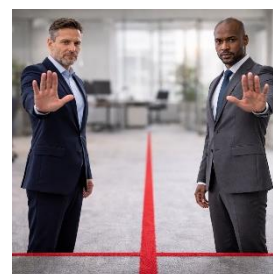
Take the
matter
seriously



Tighten internal
control



Restore
confidence



Draw a clear
line

LANGUAGE PRACTICE

Inversion

Not until the
investigation ended
did we understand the
full impact.

Still, **at no time** were
customer passwords
exposed.



Expression

at no time

not until

by no means

under no circumstances

only after

in no way

little did we know

never before

rarely



PUTTING OUT FIRES

EXERCISE 1

Complete the sentences using each expression from the vocabulary only once.

- A. Management said the first step was to _____ and understand exactly what caused the failure.
- B. The company stated it would _____ by sharing information and cooperating with customers.
- C. Senior leaders said they would _____ rather than blame a supplier or a system error.
- D. New approval rules were introduced to _____ and prevent similar incidents.
- E. Executives announced it was time to _____ between acceptable behavior and misconduct.
- F. The spokesperson confirmed the company continues to _____ despite public pressure.
- G. Rebuilding trust remains critical, and the main goal now is to _____ with the public.
- H. Once all corrective actions are completed, the company hopes to _____ and move forward.

EXERCISE 2

Rewrite each sentence so that it starts with the phrase given. Do not change the meaning.

- A. We understood the full impact only after the investigation ended.
→ **Not until** the investigation ended did we understand the full impact.
- B. The company ignored customer complaints at no point.
→ **At no time** _____
- C. We approved the change only after further testing.
→ **Only after** _____
- D. The delay was intentional in no way.
→ **In no way** _____
- E. The company is dismissing the issue by no means.
→ **By no means** _____

SUMMARY

Original tense / structure	Inversion uses	Example
Past Simple (verb)	did + subject + base verb	Not until later did we realize the mistake.
Present Simple (verb)	do / does + subject + base verb	Rarely do projects fail for one reason.
Future (will)	will + subject + base verb	Under no circumstances will this be allowed to happen again.
Verb BE (any tense)	be + subject (no do/does/did)	At no time were accounts compromised.
Perfect tenses	have / has / had + subject + past participle	Never before had we faced such pressure.
Modal verbs	modal + subject + base verb	By no means can this be ignored.

EXERCISES ANSWER KEYS

Exercise 1

- A. get to the bottom of the issue
- B. act in good faith
- C. hold themselves accountable
- D. tighten internal controls
- E. draw a clear line
- F. take the matter seriously
- G. restore confidence
- H. put this behind us

Exercise 2

- A. Not until the investigation ended **did we** understand the full impact.
- B. At no time **did** the company ignore customer complaints.
- C. Only after further testing **did** we approve the change.
- D. In no way **was** the delay intentional.
- E. By no means **is** the company dismissing the issue.